

NIKUNJ BRAHMBHATT

Financial Analyst | FP&A • Financial Modeling • Applied AI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

FP&A-focused financial analyst with 5+ years across M&A and corporate finance in the U.S. and India — budgeting, forecasting, scenario and sensitivity modeling, cost-structure analysis, and variance reporting. MBA with hands-on applied AI: built and benchmarked LLM systems that automate financial-analysis workflows at up to 1,100x lower inference cost — ready to drive AI adoption across FP&A planning, forecasting, and cost optimization.

CORE SKILLS

Financial Planning & Analysis: Budgeting & forecasting, financial modeling (DCF, LBO, merger), scenario & sensitivity analysis, variance analysis, cost-structure & COGS analysis, business case development, KPI tracking & performance reporting, monthly close support

AI Tools & Automation: LLM evaluation & benchmarking, fine-tuning (SFT, LoRA), prompt engineering, RAG, AI workflow automation, Hugging Face, Fireworks AI, Ollama, OpenAI / Anthropic SDKs

Data & Systems: Advanced Excel/VBA, Python (data analysis, ML pipelines, API integration), SQL, Tableau, SAP, Capital IQ, Bloomberg, Salesforce, Intralinks, Git/GitHub

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Investment Analyst — Piper Sandler, Minneapolis, MN

07/2024 – Present

- Own budgeting, forecasting, and reporting workstreams across live engagements — building merger, LBO, and DCF models in Excel and Python with scenario and sensitivity analysis across revenue, cost, and margin drivers that inform go/no-go decisions.
- Provide analytical support on business cases for cost savings, investment trade-offs, and process improvements, quantifying portfolio efficiencies and synergy opportunities for committees and clients.
- Partner across product, sales, engineering, supply chain, and finance teams to validate cost assumptions and track performance against long-range and annual operating plans, surfacing business trends that pose financial risk.
- Author CIMs, client memos, and board-ready decks for Managing Directors and executive audiences; drive AI adoption in analysis workflows, using Python automation to reduce manual effort and speed turnaround.

Investment Banking Analyst — HDFC Securities, Mumbai, India

06/2019 – 07/2022

- Built valuation, forecasting, and sensitivity models in Excel and Capital IQ; developed Bloomberg sector pitchbooks supporting senior bankers in client discussions.
- Designed Tableau dashboards tracking KPIs across industrials, technology, and consumer sectors, surfacing growth opportunities and cost trends for client strategy.
- Supported month-end reporting and variance analysis, reconciling actuals against forecast and summarizing key drivers for senior stakeholders.
- Partnered with corporate clients, legal, compliance, and finance teams to validate assumptions and ensure regulatory readiness for deal execution.

APPLIED AI PROJECTS — AUTOMATING FINANCIAL WORKFLOWS

Fine-Tuned LLM for Bank Comparables Analysis — Fireworks AI (open-sourced on GitHub)

05/2026

- Fine-tuned Llama 3.1 8B (SFT + LoRA) to automate bank comparable-companies analysis — a manual, repetitive analyst workflow — and designed a 5-axis, analyst-grade evaluation rubric with context-aware misuse detection.
- Benchmarked against GPT-5.5 and Claude Opus 4.7: 100% source-citation discipline (vs. 80% frontier), zero numerical hallucinations, at \$0.00009 per inference — a ~1,100x cost reduction; built end-to-end in 5 days for \$35 of compute with a reproducible eval pipeline.

Banker Trainer — Voice-Enabled AI Training Simulator — Independent build (open-sourced on GitHub)

2026

- Built a 100% local, voice-enabled AI simulator for retail bank associates (Llama 3.1 8B via Ollama, Whisper STT, Piper TTS, Streamlit): six customer personas, a live engagement meter, and an AI coach delivering structured scorecards — privacy by design for a regulated domain.
- Engineered deterministic guardrails and post-parse output repair over a probabilistic model; achieved 18/18 correct outcomes in automated stress testing and a ~7-second end-to-end voice loop.

LLM Evaluation for Financial Modeling — AI Research Contractor, Micro1 (Remote)

01/2026 – 02/2026

- Stress-tested Claude, ChatGPT, and Gemini across 40+ DCF, LBO, and merger-model prompts (15-point rubric); identified a 22% accuracy gap in AI-generated sensitivity tables vs. analyst benchmarks, shaping the lab's finance-model training pipeline.

AI-Powered F1 Race Viewing Platform (in development): architecting an immersive broadcast prototype pairing live race video with a synchronized 3D digital twin, AI-driven camera selection, and interactive viewer controls.

EDUCATION

MBA — University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee (2024) | BCA (Computer Applications) — GLS University, India (2019)